

Version 2 — Cleaned Contextual Discussion Notes

Prepared by: Manus AI

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Audio duration: approximately 53 minutes and 52 seconds

Scope applied: These notes intentionally exclude greetings, side comments, unrelated pre-meeting conversation, and general non-business chatter. The content below focuses on the substantive discussion about termination/offboarding process design, ACS/1541 changes, automation, rules, compliance, and related operational requirements.

Meeting Notes: Termination Process Review and Automation Planning (Version 2)

Executive Summary

The meeting focused on reviewing the current termination process for agents and service representatives, identifying pain points, and discussing automation and simplification opportunities. Key topics included eliminating the outdated 1541 form, automating termination tasks, clarifying termination reasons (especially around retirement), managing appointment and registration transfers, and ensuring consistent handling of suspensions and disclosures. The group agreed on moving towards a rules-driven, automated system that reduces manual errors and streamlines approvals, with zones playing a more active role in initiating terminations. Plans were made to refine user stories, engage stakeholders, and hold recurring meetings to advance the project.

Participants / Speaker Mapping

- **Kathleen:** Subject matter expert on current termination processes and system screens.
- **Rocco:** Lead on automation and system design, providing technical insights.
- **Serena:** Participant, familiar with user stories and process context.
- **Nick:** Participant interested in system screens and process details.

- **Christine:** Participant contributing to discussion on suspensions and compliance.
- **Others referenced:** Marissa, Natasha, Margaret, Betsy, Tarun, Eric Kohler, Samantha, Charmaine (various roles in compliance, zones, and operations).

Main Discussion Context

- The current termination process involves manual completion of a 1541 form by the Geo Office (GO), which is error-prone and often delayed.
- There is confusion around termination reasons, especially distinguishing retirement from resignation or termination.
- Zones currently have limited responsibility but are expected to take a more active role in initiating terminations for established agents.
- Automation is planned to replace manual forms and questionnaires, leveraging existing data from onboarding and contract management systems.
- Compliance and CCD (Compliance and Disclosure Department) reviews are critical for certain termination categories.
- Managing appointment and registration transfers, especially when agents change roles (e.g., agent to LSA), is complex and costly if done manually.
- Suspension handling during termination notice periods varies by zone and lacks consistency.

Current-State Process

Step/Component	Description / Pain Points
1541 Form	Manual form filled by Geo Office with termination details; prone to errors, often saved but not submitted.
Termination Reason Selection	Confusion in selecting correct reason (retired, active, resigned, terminated); retirement lumped under termination causing errors.
Letter Requirement	Termination letters must be sent and received before processing 1541; often delayed or forgotten.

Appointment/Registration	Manual cancellation or transfer of appointments and registrations; costly and error-prone.
CCD Review	Required for certain termination reasons (e.g., "term other" or background issues); currently manual and inconsistent.
Suspension Handling	Suspension during 30-day termination notice varies by zone; inconsistent application and communication.
Auto Terminations	Auto terminations require letters and zone approval; frequent reversals and special handling needed.

Target-State / Automation Ideas

Area	Proposed Solution
Eliminate 1541 Form	Remove questionnaire; automate task creation based on onboarding and contract data (CAT-1 feed).
Termination Reason Options	Add distinct "Retired" radio button separate from termination to reduce confusion.
Letter Automation	Auto-generate termination letters upon approval; send directly to correspondence system (e.g., Pfizer/Fiserv).
Zone Responsibility	Zones initiate terminations for established agents; GO manages downstream processing.
Appointment/Registration	Automate appointment re-appointments or transfers when agents change roles; add checkboxes to suppress cancellations.
Suspension Handling	Add prompt for zones to decide on suspension during termination; automate suspension task creation.
CCD Review Automation	Auto-route terminations with disclosure or background issues to CCD; CCD to finalize and trigger letter generation.

Hold Queue for Terminations	Implement a hold queue to delay downstream processing (e.g., FDAS updates) until effective termination date, typically 30 days out.
Reversal Handling	Allow zones to retract or modify terminations before final processing; reduce manual corrections.

Key Decisions and Agreements

- The 1541 form and its questionnaire will be eliminated; automation will replace manual data entry.
- Retirement will be a separate termination reason to avoid confusion.
- Zones will be responsible for initiating terminations of established agents; GO will manage the rest.
- Termination letters will be auto-generated and sent upon approval, removing manual letter writing.
- A hold queue will be implemented to manage the 30-day notice period before final termination processing.
- Suspension decisions will be prompted during termination initiation and handled consistently across zones.
- CCD will receive auto-routed cases for review based on termination reason and disclosures.
- Appointment and registration transfers will be automated where possible, with options to suppress cancellations.
- The system will enforce rules based on contract type and agent status to control who can initiate terminations.
- Recurring meetings will be held twice weekly (Mondays and Wednesdays) to refine user stories and engage stakeholders.

Open Questions / Risks

Topic	Description
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Suspension Consistency	How to standardize suspension language and enforcement across zones?
Appointment Transfer Logic	Detailed handling of appointment and registration transfers, especially for role changes (agent to LSA).
Reversal Process	How to efficiently manage reversals or retractions of terminations in the automated system?
CCD Review Criteria	Finalizing which termination reasons require CCD review and how to handle borderline cases.
Letter Automation Details	Technical approach for letter generation and integration with correspondence systems (API vs. file transfer).
Hold Queue Management	Handling changes during the hold period, such as switching from termination to resignation.
Volume Impact	Balancing development effort for low-volume cases (e.g., agent to LSA transitions) versus mass terminations.
Integration with Mainframe	How new termination data and code numbers will be communicated to legacy systems (e.g., mainframe).

Action Items

Owner	Task	Due Date / Notes
Kathleen	Provide high-level walkthrough of current termination screens and process permutations.	Next meeting
Rocco	Develop automation rules engine for termination reasons, contract types, and suspension prompts.	Ongoing
Serena	Assist with refining user stories and updating terminology	Ongoing

	(e.g., FINRA registration requirements).	
Team	Review and update termination matrix and rules for CCD routing and disclosures.	Before stakeholder meetings
Serena	Schedule recurring meetings twice weekly (Mondays and Wednesdays) and coordinate with stakeholders.	Immediate
Rocco	Coordinate with CCD and zones to align on termination and suspension processes and responsibilities.	Ongoing
Kathleen	Provide list of Department of Insurance commissioners and email addresses for letter automation.	ASAP
Team	Define logic for appointment and registration transfers, including suppression checkboxes.	Next phase
Team	Investigate hold queue implementation for termination processing delays and reversal handling.	Next phase
Serena	Compile extensive stakeholder list and schedule meetings with zones, CCD, and compliance groups.	ASAP

Glossary of Terms

Term / Acronym	Definition
1541	Current manual termination form used by Geo Offices to submit termination details.
GO (Geo Office)	Local office responsible for agent management and termination processing.

Zone	Regional management level responsible for initiating terminations for established agents.
CCD	Compliance and Disclosure Department responsible for reviewing certain termination cases.
EPM	Enterprise Process Management system used for task automation and workflow management.
FDAS	System or database updated with termination and registration status.
TAS / PTAS	Contract types; TAS and PTAS allow managing partner to initiate termination at will.
LSA	Licensed Sales Assistant, a role that agents may transition to or from.
U5	Form used to terminate registrations with FINRA.
CAT-1	Automated feed or data source used to replace manual 1541 form.
Auto Term	Automated termination process triggered by system rules and data feeds.
DMS	Document Management System where termination letters and documents are stored.
Pfizer / Fiserv	Correspondence systems used to send termination letters and other communications.
NASD	National Association of Securities Dealers, related to registration status.
PDB Alerts	Alerts related to licensing and registration issues, such as failure to renew licenses.

These notes capture the key points and decisions from the meeting, providing a clear foundation for next steps in automating and improving the termination process.